CAMPAIGN WATCH · SENATE DISTRICT 13

Who Is Paying for This Race

All money raised, spent, and spent by outside groups — through September 15, 2026
Jared Gapinski (R, on ballot) · Aaron Brutger (R, write-in) · Trent Dilks (DFL, on ballot)

Every number here comes from reports filed with the Minnesota Campaign Finance Board. Nothing is estimated; where a figure is incomplete, this page says so.

1. The money at a glance

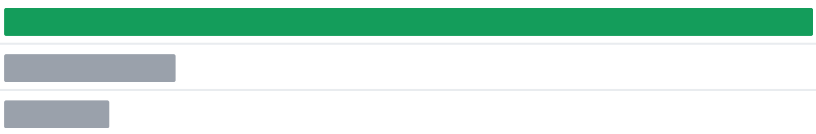
THROUGH SEPT. 15, 2026	GAPINSKI	BRUTGER	DILKS
Raised by the campaign	$42,416	$14,936	$24,435
Spent by the campaign	$7,219	$4,573	$13,642
Cash still on hand	$35,197	$10,363	$10,793
Spent by outside groups to help	$72,840	$0	$0
Total money behind the candidate	**$115,256**	**$14,936**	**$24,435**

Campaign totals cover the full election cycle (Dec. 2025 – July 20, 2026, the close of the last report candidates have filed). Outside spending runs through Sept. 15. Filed report Board records

$72,840

spent by one outside group, Pro Jobs Majority, to support Jared Gapinski — all of it between June 22 and July 27, before the August 11 primary. That is **4.9 times** everything Aaron Brutger's campaign raised in the entire race, and **1.7 times** what Gapinski's own campaign raised.

Relative size of the money, primary period



August 11 primary result: Gapinski 65.9%, Brutger 34.1%. Brutger held the Republican Party endorsement; Gapinski did not. Secretary of State Press

2. The outside spending, line by line

Outside groups may spend unlimited amounts for or against a candidate so long as they do not coordinate with the campaign. The candidate neither reports nor controls this money.

DATE	GROUP	WHAT IT PAID FOR	PAID TO	AMOUNT
Jun 22	Pro Jobs Majority	Door-knocking	In Field Strategies	$53,072
Jul 1	Pro Jobs Majority	Literature & design	Arena Communications	$4,891
Jul 23	Pro Jobs Majority	Mail	Arena Communications	$7,410
Jul 27	Pro Jobs Majority	Mail	Arena Communications	$7,467
Total supporting Jared Gapinski				**$72,840**

No outside group reported spending for or against Aaron Brutger or Trent Dilks in this race, either direction, at any point. Board records

3. Where Pro Jobs Majority gets its money

2025–2026 DONORS	AMOUNT
Minnesota Chamber of Commerce	$3,491,976
MN Multi Housing Association	$100,000
All money in	**$3,591,976**

What it spent in 2026

$1,585,509 statewide: supporting 10 legislative candidates and opposing 5. Gapinski ranked 6th among the ten it supported.

Chair: Laura Bordelon, St. Paul. Treasurer: Annette Kojetin, St. Paul. Registered with the Board since 2010.

The Chamber supplied 97% of this cycle's funding and 98% of the $11.3 million the group has raised since 2015. It has no other significant source.

4. Who gave directly to each campaign

These are the campaigns' own filed reports — every dollar each candidate raised.

SOURCE OF MONEY	GAPINSKI	BRUTGER	DILKS
Business, trade & professional PACs	$4,000	$0	$0
Registered lobbyists	$1,500	$0	$0
A sitting senator's committee	$1,000	$0	$0
Party units (district & county)	$0	$5,000	$4,000
Named donors & candidate's own money	$30,670	$4,095	$11,185
Donations under $200 (names not public)	$5,246	$5,841	$9,250
Total raised	**$42,416**	**$14,936**	**$24,435**

The three sections that follow list every organized donor — PACs, lobbyists, party units and other political committees. Individual donors are not listed by name for any candidate. Dates are as reported; a few gifts appear in the giving committee's filing before the candidate's.

5. The money behind Jared Gapinski

16 gifts from 15 organized sources — $9,400

DATE	SOURCE	TYPE	AMOUNT
Jun 12	MAFMIC Political Action Committee	Insurance trade PAC	$500
Jun 22	MN AGPAC	Agriculture PAC	$250
Jul 6	Optometry PAC	Professional PAC	$1,000
Jul 6	Joel Carlson	Registered lobbyist	$1,000
Jul 7	Sen. Gary Dahms Senate Committee	Sitting senator	$1,000
Jul 10	MN Local Business Alliance PAC	Business PAC	$1,000
Jul 10	Haulers for Choice	Industry PAC	$500
Jul 12	MN State Patrol Troopers Association	Public-employee PAC	$250
Jul 13	MN Cable Communications Assn PAC	Industry PAC	$1,000
Jul 17	Ward Einess	Registered lobbyist	$500
Jul 27	Lockridge Grindal Nauen State Political Fund	Law/lobbying firm fund	$500
Sep 1	MN Professional Fire Fighters PAC	Public-employee PAC	$500
Sep 3	MAFMIC Political Action Committee	Insurance trade PAC	$500
Sep 3	MN Independent Insurance Agents PAC	Insurance trade PAC	$250
Sep 8	CAR, Committee of Automotive Retailers	Industry PAC	$500
Sep 15	NFIB Minnesota PAC	Small-business PAC	$150
Total organized money			**$9,400**

Gapinski reported no party-unit money at any point. Five of these gifts, totaling $1,900, arrived after the August 11 primary.

6. The money behind Aaron Brutger

4 gifts from 3 organized sources — $5,500

DATE	SOURCE	TYPE	AMOUNT
Apr 8	Benton County Republicans	County party unit	$1,000
May 14	13th Senate District Republicans	District party unit	$3,000
Jul 14	Republican Liberty Caucus of Minnesota	Ideological group	$500
Jul 17	13th Senate District Republicans	District party unit	$1,000
Total organized money			**$5,500**

No business PAC, trade association, registered lobbyist or sitting legislator's committee gave to Brutger at any point. Nothing arrived after the primary.

7. The money behind Trent Dilks

2 gifts from 1 organized source — $4,000

DATE	SOURCE	TYPE	AMOUNT
Mar 29	13th Senate District DFL	District party unit	$3,000
Jul 15	13th Senate District DFL	District party unit	$1,000
Total organized money			**$4,000**

No business PAC, trade association, registered lobbyist or sitting legislator's committee gave to Dilks at any point. Nothing arrived after the primary.

8. The small-donor picture

Donations of $200 or less are reported to the Board only as a lump sum, so the donors' names are not public. The totals are, and they show how differently these three campaigns were funded.

MONEY RAISED IN SMALL AMOUNTS	GAPINSKI	BRUTGER	DILKS
Total from donations under $200	$5,246	$5,841	$9,250
Share of everything the campaign raised	12%	39%	38%
Donations of $200+ listed by name	45	39	66
Average size of those listed donations	$826	$233	$230
Donated goods and services received	$0	$77	$242
Spending too small to be itemized	$280	$1,163	$1,483

Across 93 Minnesota Senate campaigns that raised at least $10,000 in 2026, the typical campaign drew **34%** of its money from donations under $200. Measured on that same 2026 basis, Gapinski is at 12% — the sixth lowest of the 93 — while Brutger (36%) and Dilks (37%) sit near the middle. `Board records`

Put another way: **78% of Gapinski's named money** came in as 29 separate gifts of exactly $1,000, the legal maximum. Twelve of those, worth $12,400, were received on a single day — July 20, the close of the reporting period. Brutger's largest individual donation in the whole race was $300; Dilks's was $1,000.

9. What changed after the primary

Between Aug. 12 and Sept. 15, five more political committees reported sending Gapinski a combined $1,900: the Fire Fighters, MAFMIC, Automotive Retailers, Independent Insurance Agents and NFIB PACs. **No committee reported sending money to Brutger or Dilks in that period**, and no outside group reported new spending in this race after July 27.

10. What this does — and does not — show

It shows: one candidate had the backing of organized, Capitol-based money — business PACs, lobbyists, a sitting senator, and a Chamber-funded group that outspent his own campaign. The other two had none of it, and nearly all of it arrived before the primary.

It does not show: that any contribution was improper, that a law was broken, or that anything was promised in return. It does not prove money decided the primary — endorsements, name recognition, geography and turnout all move votes, and none are measured here.

Data disclaimer. Minnesota CFB Bulk data, extracted September 15, 2026. Itemized gifts over $200 only. Donors matched by registration number. All figures are floors.



Campaign Watch is Alethical's public-record research series. Full data and sources on request. alethical.com